

# NICHOLAS P. SWEENEY

University of Manchester, United Kingdom

[Email](#) ◇ [Website](#)

## CURRENT EMPLOYMENT

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**Fellow**, Alliance Manchester Business School, University of Manchester 2025 –  
Three year appointment as the *Sir Terry Leahy Fellow of Urban and Regional Economics*

## PUBLICATIONS

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Sweeney, N. P. (2026) ‘Spatial Variation in Mobility Across England: Evidence from 21 Million Geo-coded Credit-Card Flows’. *Spatial Economic Analysis*. [DOI](#).

Sweeney, N. P. (2026) ‘Devolution and Economic Growth in English City Regions’. *Urban Studies*. [DOI](#).

Sweeney, N. P. (2026) ‘Challenging the S of Mayoral Strategic Authorities: Standardisation Over Strategy?’. *The Political Quarterly*. [DOI](#).

Sweeney, N. P. (2025) ‘Devolution, Health and Health Inequalities in Greater Manchester’. *Social Science & Medicine*. [DOI](#).

Sweeney, N. P. (2025) ‘Devolution and Democratic Engagement in England’. *Political Geography*. [DOI](#).

## WORKING PAPERS

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Sweeney, N. P. (2026) ‘A method, data, and quality note introducing the Dynamic Global Microgeographic Patent Database’. [DOI](#).

Sweeney, N. P. (2026) ‘The Interactive Temporal Microfoundations of Agglomeration Economies and Their Implications’. [DOI](#).

## EDUCATION

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**Land Economy, PhD**, St Catharine’s College, University of Cambridge 2022 – 2026  
*Started 1 October 2022; submitted 26 September 2025; graduated 22 May 2026*

- **Thesis & Funding:** ‘Devolution and Space in England: Empirical Essays on Economic Growth, Democratic Engagement and Health’; fully funded by the ESRC Doctoral Training Partnership; [DOI](#).

**Land Economy by Research, MPhil**, Darwin College, University of Cambridge 2021 – 2022  
*Distinction (75%)*

- **Awards & Achievements:** £12,000 Cambridge Trust (Grace Goh Studentship); 87% in Research Methods

**Land Economy, BA**, Jesus College, University of Cambridge 2018 – 2021  
*Double First-class (73.4%)*

- **Awards & Achievements:** Most marks in cohort across all three years; prizes for best final-year dissertation (82%), best overall second-year performance (71.6%), best overall (71%) and Economics, first-year performance

## ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

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**Sir Terry Leahy Fellow** 2025 –

- Research spanning multiple themes surrounding subnational inequalities and growth, with a particular focus on modelling innovation, mobility and political patterns of discontent using big data
- Winner of Best Presentation at Regional Science Association International (British and Irish Section) Early Career Colloquium 2026
- Data Lead on agreements with TravelTime API, The Elections Centre, Rail Data Marketplace

**University of Cambridge Interviewer** 2022 – *Trinity Hall* & 2024 – *Sidney Sussex*

- Entrusted to be one of four interviewers for candidates for undergraduate Land Economy applications
- Consulted on final selection of candidates, justifying my reasoning based on objective criteria

**University of Cambridge Supervisor**

Autumn 2022

Department of Land Economy

Cambridge, UK

- Supervised 60 second year undergraduates on ‘Paper 11: Land and Urban Economics’, marking essays, giving feedback and clarifying technical and theoretical problems in small group formats
- Covered the topics of agglomeration, reasons for co-location of highly skilled couples, retail accessibility as a determinant of place attractiveness and whether big cities were ‘bad places to live’

**OTHER ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES**

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- Dissemination invitations (theme, date; earliest first): University of Cambridge (innovation geography, Dec 2025); The Productivity Institute (innovation geography, Jan 2026); London School of Economics (innovation geography, Feb 2026); Ministry of Housing, Communities and Local Government (devolution, Feb 2026); HM Treasury (devolution, Mar 2026); RSAI-BIS Conference Belfast (big data mobility, invited early career researcher, May 2026)
- Journal Referee for: Regional Studies
- Advisory positions: Scientific Advisory Board member for the Biologics Regional Innovation and Technology Ecosystem ([BRITE](#)) UKRI project

**POLICY EXPERIENCE**

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**Data Science Intern**

September 2023 – March 2024

Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development

Paris, France

- Recruited to employ Natural Language Processing techniques to explore the potential for big data (full text job listings) to illustrate how the digital and green (‘twin’) transition is impacting labour markets
- During my internship, I also focused on analysing sector-specific datasets, particularly in mining, using R and Python to present findings for the LESI Division

**Researcher**

2020 – 2021

– [MillNET](#) <sup>i</sup>

Summer 2021 – *Virtual*

Analysed longitudinal household income and diet data from The Gambia and Ethiopia through COVID-19.

– [ASEAN Development Outlook Report](#)

Summer 2020 – *Virtual*

Contributed evidence notes and proofreading across identity, environment, livelihoods and social welfare/health.

**SKILLS**

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|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Data access</b>   | Office of National Statistics Accredited Researcher (no. 36517, exp. Nov. 2026)                    |
| <b>Software</b>      | Proficient in <b>Python</b> , <b>R</b> , <b>LaTeX</b> , <b>STATA</b> , intermediate in <b>QGIS</b> |
| <b>Communication</b> | Intermediate French language                                                                       |

**OTHER**

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|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Societies and interests</b> | University of Manchester Humanities Fellows Committee, Hawks’ Club President & Committee, Cambridge University Association Football Club Secretary |
| <b>Date of birth</b>           | 19 July 2000                                                                                                                                       |